

Small is Big Maruti to Tata Nano

In 1983, the Maruti 800 revolutionised the way India travelled. "Two years later, it was the largest-selling car in India," recalled INDIA TODAY in 2003. Almost 25 years later, "when Tata drove the Nano on to the stage, it was clear that Indian innovation had shifted to a higher orbit," noted INDIA TODAY in January 2008. Clearly, good things continue to come in small packages.



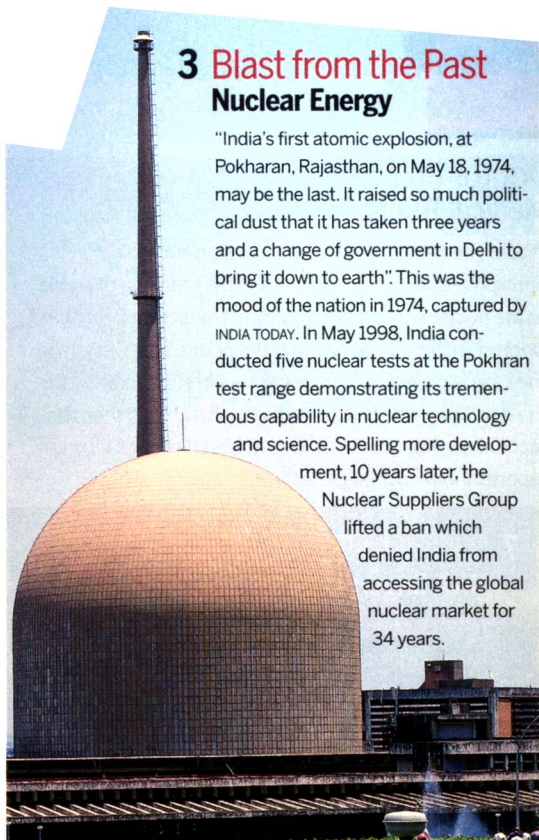
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2 The Right Call Telecommunications

The modernisation of telephone systems got underway in 1986 when Mahanagar Telephone Nigam was established to operate systems in Bombay and Delhi. "There's good news for subscribers: the waiting list of 3.7 lakh in the two cities could disappear by 1990," noted INDIA TODAY in 1986. The current situation is best described by this 2006 report: "Telecommunication has gone from a total of five million telephone lines in 1991 to five million telephones every month."

3 Blast from the Past Nuclear Energy

"India's first atomic explosion, at Pokharan, Rajasthan, on May 18, 1974, may be the last. It raised so much political dust that it has taken three years and a change of government in Delhi to bring it down to earth". This was the mood of the nation in 1974, captured by INDIA TODAY. In May 1998, India conducted five nuclear tests at the Pokhran test range demonstrating its tremendous capability in nuclear technology and science. Spelling more development, 10 years later, the Nuclear Suppliers Group lifted a ban which denied India from accessing the global nuclear market for 34 years.



HEMANT PITHWA

4 Teching the Cake Biotechnology

"Biotechnology can be used to increase productivity with cash crops and a whole range of vegetables. Experts believe this tissue culture-based business has enormous potential." That was INDIA TODAY's take on biotechnology in September 1991. It got better, as an August 2006 report counted that "2,378 biotechnology patent applications were filed in India between 1995 and 2003".

5 World Calling IT sector

India churns out two million English-speaking graduates each year, employable at wages 80 per cent less than their Western counterparts. No wonder, said INDIA TODAY in 2002, that it is the new global IT capital "with over 336 call centres springing up in the past five years, providing jobs to over 1.5 million people."

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